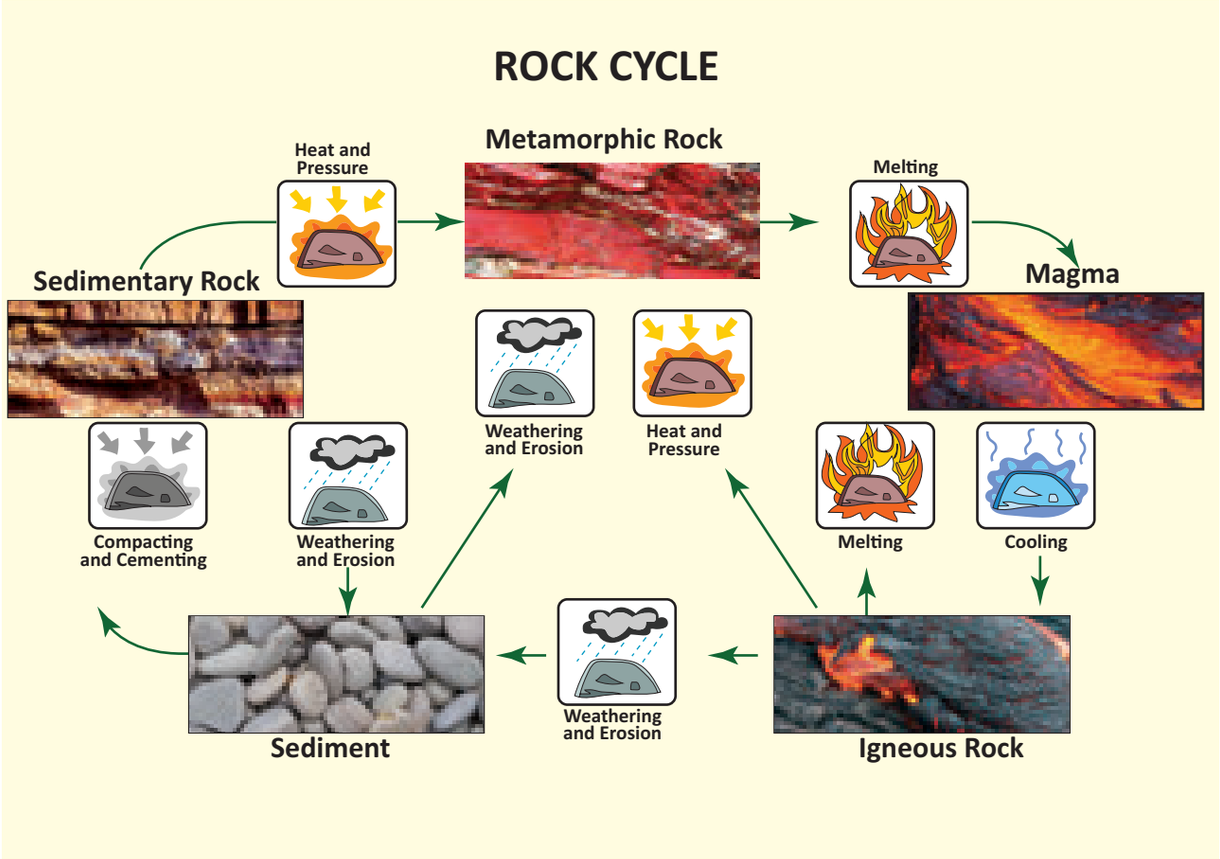
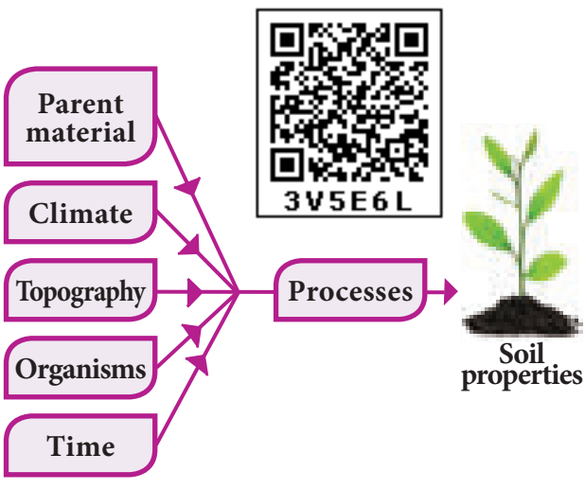


Rock Cycle

Soil and its Formation



Soil is a mixture of organic matter, minerals, gases, liquids and organisms that together support life. **Soil** minerals form the basis of soil. It forms on the surface of the earth. It is known as the '**skin of the earth**'. Soils are formed from rocks (parent material) through the **processes** of weathering and natural erosion. Water, wind, temperature change, gravity, chemical interaction, living organisms and pressure differences all help break down parent material. It leads to the formation of loose material. In course of time, they further break down into fine particles. This process release the minerals locked in the rock fragments. Later on, the vegetative cover which develop in that region forms humus content in the soil. This way the soil gets matured gradually.



World Soil Day is observed on 5th December, every year

Soil Composition

The basic components of soil are mineral, organic matter, water and air. It consists of about 45% mineral, 5% organic matter, 25% of water and 25% air. It is only a generalized fact. The composition of soil varies from place to place and time to time.

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